

Ava De Mello

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto (GPA 3.75)

HBSc in Geographic Information Systems

Mississauga, ON

Sept. 2024 – June 2028

University of Toronto (GPA 3.75)

HBA in Technology, Coding and Society Co-op

Mississauga, ON

Sept. 2024 – June 2028

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer & UX Research Contributor

Lodaria

November 2025 – Present

Toronto, ON

- Conducted competitive analysis of 10+ platforms, identifying design gaps that informed early product strategy
- Collaborated with user groups to apply user-centered design methods, translating feedback into structured problem statements
- Designed 14+ high-fidelity interactive prototypes in Figma to support rapid iteration and product decisions
- Created visual assets including UI graphics and brand identity, ensuring consistency across product materials
- Synthesized research insights into UX flows and wireframes to guide product and engineering direction

Associate Media Production Director

ICCIT Council

October 2025 – March 2026

University of Toronto Mississauga

- Directed 7+ digital media campaigns supporting student initiatives and outreach
- Produced content reaching 20,000+ students across Instagram and TikTok platforms
- Increased engagement by leveraging content trends, achieving 4,000+ average views per video
- Managed end-to-end production including concept development, graphics, and executive coordination

Multimedia Editor

Vision Magazine

January 2026 – May 2026

University of Toronto Mississauga

- Contributed as writer, videographer, and editor in the production of a documentary project
- Conducted 7+ interviews using professional camera and audio equipment
- Edited footage using Adobe Premiere Pro and CapCut to produce a cohesive final product
- Presented documentary to an audience of 100+ attendees, showcasing student work

APEC Club President

St. Edmund Campion

January 2022 – Summer 2025

Brampton, ON

- Founded and grew a student club to 30+ members across multiple grade levels
- Directed an award-winning film featured in the 2025 VFF Awards, raising \$3,500 for the school community
- Taught animation fundamentals and mentored peers in creative project development

Volunteer

Port Credit Busker Festival

August 2025

Mississauga, ON

- Supported crowd coordination and safety operations for a 50,000+ attendee public festival
- Assisted staff with first aid response, contributing to a safe event environment
- Supported fire safety operations during live performances using proper safety procedures
- Coordinated post-event data collection, contributing to 5,000+ attendee surveys

Division 1 U19 Player & U12 Coach

Basketball Program

June 2021 – May 2024

Brampton, ON

- Designed and led weekly training sessions for 15 youth athletes
- Coached across 20+ practices, developing drills tailored to skill progression
- Fostered an inclusive team environment while mentoring players and supporting development

PROJECTS

PathwayR UX Competition Winning Solution | *Figma, UX Research* October 2025 – November 2025

- Designed a stakeholder-focused UX solution that placed 1st among 10 competing teams
- Conducted user research with 2 university professors to identify workflow pain points
- Developed 5 high-fidelity design frameworks to communicate product direction
- Synthesized research into structured UX flows and design rationales for presentation

Nom Roller Interactive Installation | *Figma, Prototyping, Usability Testing* Summer 2025

- Designed and prototyped a tangible user experience installation during a 72-hour design sprint
- Created interaction flows focused on intuitive physical-to-digital usability
- Presented prototype at Toronto Tech Week and collected live feedback from 20+ participants
- Analyzed usability observations and survey responses to identify future design improvements

Student Documentary Production | *Premiere Pro, CapCut, Videography* January 2026 – May 2026

- Produced a documentary as writer, videographer, and editor for a student publication
- Conducted 7+ filmed interviews using professional camera and audio equipment
- Edited footage into a final narrative using Adobe Premiere Pro and CapCut
- Presented the completed documentary to an audience of 100+ attendees

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, Python, Java, HTML/CSS, R

Design & Creative Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Canva, Unity, Maya

UX Research & Methods: User Testing, Interview Synthesis, Qualitative Coding, Prototyping, Systems Thinking

Data & Technical Tools: SQLite, ArcGIS, Zotero, Overleaf

Developer & Productivity Tools: Git, VS Code, Office 365, Notion, Google Suite, Zoom, Microsoft Teams

Certifications: IBM Full Stack Developer Certification (In Progress), First Aid & CPR (Valid through 2026), Apple Animation Workshop, DPCDSB Skills Challenge for 2D Animation (3rd Place)